



A 1635 view of Fort Zeelandia, in Tainan, present-day Taiwan.

**FOR ALMOST FOUR DECADES** the **Dutch East India Company** had controlled western **Formosa** (Taiwan), with its trading base Fort Zeelandia at its heart. Hostile to this alien presence, the Chinese Ming dynasty besieged the fort, which was inadequately supplied by water, and captured it in February 1662. The **Dutch** were forced to **abandon Formosa**.

The **pace of scientific investigation** in the 17th century led Europe's scientists to share ideas, and then to form bodies devoted to a better understanding of science. In 1662, the **Royal Society**, the world's oldest such scientific body, was founded in London. That it had royal approval showed how both the practical application of **science** and the pursuit of **pure knowledge** had become of interest to the state.



The people of New Amsterdam plead with its director-general, Peter Stuyvesant, not to resist the English warships gathering in the harbor.

**NUMEROUS ENGLISH RAIDS** on Dutch shipping and trading posts in this year were the result of an **English desire to win** as much Dutch trade as possible. The most successful of these took place on August 27, when a small English fleet arrived at **New Amsterdam**, the capital of the Dutch North American colony of New Netherland, and demanded its surrender. Director-general Peter Stuyvesant eventually complied. By March 1665, the Second Anglo-Dutch War broke out.

The **Austro-Turkish War** that broke out in 1663 reached a climax in August 1664, when an

#### Battle of St. Gotthard

*This woodcut, based on a drawing by Adolf Ehrhardt, shows an attack by the Habsburg cavalry in the defeat of the Ottomans at St. Gotthard.*



“ONE IS EASILY  
FOOLED BY  
THAT WHICH  
ONE LOVES.”

*Molière, from Tartuffe, 1664*

Ottoman army, intent on capturing Vienna, was defeated by a Habsburg force at **St. Gotthard, Hungary**. Although the Ottomans gained favorable peace terms, their **invasion was curtailed**.

Alarmed at English and Dutch domination of trade with Asia, in 1664 the **French East India Company** was established, with royal patronage. It was lavishly funded, but it resulted only in the settlement of the island of Réunion in the Indian Ocean and a **handful of trading posts** in India.



This representation of London's Great Plague shows, in the center foreground, the Angel of Death holding an hourglass and a spear.



**THE PUBLICATION IN THIS YEAR OF** *Micrographia*, by English natural philosopher and polymath Robert Hooke (1635–1703), was the first work **under the patronage of the Royal Society**. It was not merely the first time that those other than a closed circle of specialists had been made aware of the remarkable world revealed by **microscopes**. His drawings of an ant, louse, and flea, lovingly detailed and precisely executed, sparked particular astonishment at the complexity of this hitherto **unsuspected microworld**. It was, according to diarist Samuel Pepys, “the most ingenious book that I ever read in my life.” Of greater significance was that Hooke was the **first to use the term “cell”** for the smallest unit

#### Hooke's findings

*This page from Robert Hooke's 1665 publication, Micrographia, shows a detailed illustration of an ant. Hooke had drawn the ant after viewing it under his microscope, which is shown here.*



of a living organism, the term derived from the fact the cells Hooke observed reminded him of a monk's cell.

The year 1665 also saw the last outbreak of **bubonic plague in England**. The disease was concentrated mostly in London, where, at its height in September, 7,000 a week were dying. In the 18 months the **plague ravaged the city**, 100,000 people died.

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MILLION  
THE PRICE  
IN LIVRES  
FOR WHICH  
FRANCE  
BOUGHT  
DUNKIRK

1662 Charles II sells Dunkirk, English since 1658, to Louis XIV  
July 1662 Royal Society, founded  
February 1662 Chinese force Dutch to abandon Formosa  
1663 Austro-Turkish War begins (to 1664)

England attacks Dutch West African trading posts  
August 1 Battle of St. Gotthard sees Austrians defeat Ottomans  
Dutch partially take Guiana from England  
French playwright Molière (1622–73) writes Tartuffe  
French East India Company established  
Marathas capture Surat, India  
September 24 Peter Stuyvesant surrenders New Amsterdam, in North America, to an English naval force  
Treaty of Vasvar ends Austro-Turkish War

January 12 French mathematician Pierre de Fermat dies (b. 1601)  
April Great Plague begins, London  
Second Anglo-Dutch War begins (to 1667)  
New Jersey founded by English settlers  
Battle of Montes Claros sees Anglo-Portuguese force defeat Spain  
Robert Hooke publishes Micrographia  
September 17 Philip IV of Spain dies (b. 1605)  
October 29 Battle of Mowila sees Portuguese defeat and kill António I of Kongo kingdom